Jared Vasil

Postdoctoral Fellow
Indiana University
jvasil@iu.edu
https://jaredvasil.github.io/

Keywords

development; evolution; self-conception; communication; collaboration; Bayes

Professional Appointments

Postdoctoral Fellow (2026 – current)
Center for Possible Minds, Indiana University

Postdoctoral Associate (2024-2026)
Department of Psychology, New York University

Education

Ph.D., Department of Psychology and Neuroscience, Duke University, 2018 – 2024
Advisor: Michael Tomasello

B.S., Psychology (*summa cum laude*), University of Florida, 2014 – 2018
B.A., Linguistics (*cum laude*), University of Florida
Minor Concentration: Philosophy

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

[14] **Vasil**, J., & Tomasello, M. Cultural Common Ground and Four-Year-Olds' Referential Informativeness. (forthcoming). *Journal of Child Language*.
[13] Rivero, A., **Vasil, J.**, & Tomasello, M. (2026). Two- and three-year-olds coordinate decisions in dyads and triads. *Child Development*. https://doi.org/10.1093/chidev/aacag167
[12] Yilmaz, D., **Vasil**, J., Rhodes, M. (2026). Effects of Generics and Contextual Cues on 3- and 4-Year-Olds' Normative Inferences. *Proceedings of the Cognitive Science Society*. https://escholarship.org/uc/item/2hn4n67d
[11] Li, L & **Vasil**, J. (2026). Phylogenetic, Ontogenetic, and Logical Critiques of Mental State Minimalism. *European Journal of Developmental Psychology*. https://doi.org/10.1080/17405629.2025.2607730
[10] **Vasil**, J. (2025). Shared intentionality may have been favored by persistence hunting in *Homo erectus*. *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*. (Commentary) https://doi.org/10.1017/S0140525X24000979
[9] **Vasil**, J., Provençal, M., & Tomasello, M. (2024). Effects of "We"-framing and Partner Number on 2- and 3-Year-Olds' Sense of Commitment. *Cognitive Development*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cogdev.2024.101511
[8] **Vasil**, J., Capoot, C., & Tomasello, M. (2024). Effects of group entitativity on young English-speaking children's interpretation of inclusive *We*. *PLoS ONE*. https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0306556

[7] **Vasil**, J., Price, D., & Tomasello, M. (2024). Thought and Language: Effects of Groupmindedness on Young Children's Interpretation of Exclusive *We*. *Child Development*. https://doi.org/10.1111/cdev.14049
[6] **Vasil**, J., Moore, C., & Tomasello, M. (2023). Thought and Language: Association of Groupmindedness with Young English-speaking Children's Production of Pronouns. *First Language*. https://doi.org/10.1177/01427237231169398
[5] **Vasil**, J. (2023). A New Look at Young Children's Referential Informativeness. *Perspectives on Psychological Science*. https://doi.org/10.1177/17456916221112072
[4] **Vasil**, J. (2022). The Study of Rational Framing Effects Needs Developmental Psychology. *Behavioral and Brain Sciences*. (Commentary) https://doi.org/10.1017/S0140525X2200005X
[3] **Vasil**, J., & Tomasello, M. (2022). Effects of "We"-framing on Young Children's Commitment, Sharing, and Helping. *Journal of Experimental Child Psychology*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jecp.2021.105278
[2] **Vasil**, J., Badcock, P., Constant, A., Friston, K., & Ramstead, M. J. D. (2020). A World unto Itself: Human Communication as Active Inference. *Frontiers in Psychology*. https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2020.00417
[1] Li, L., **Vasil**, J., & Negoita, S. (2020). What you mean is more important than how you say it: Envisioning intention-oriented brain-to-speech decoding. *Journal of Consciousness Studies*, 27(1-2), 71-93.

Manuscripts

In Preparation

- **Vasil**, J., Boo, C., Boudreau, G., Johnson, J., & Rhodes, M. A Comparison of Three Measures of 4- to 6-Year-Olds' Academic Gender Stereotyping. *To be submitted to Child Development*.
- Williams, S., **Vasil**, J., & Tomasello, M. Effects of Explicit Commitments and Promises on 3- and 5-Year-Olds' Sense of Commitment. *To be Submitted to Journal of Experimental Child Psychology*.
- **Vasil, J**. A Tutorial on Simulation-Based Sample Size Planning in Bayesian Generalized Linear Mixed Models with Tailored Data Simulation. *To be submitted to Advances in Methods and Practices in Psychological Science*.
- **Vasil, J**. Self-Conception in *Homo*. *To be submitted to Behavioral and Brain Sciences (Target Article)*.
- **Vasil**, J., & Rhodes, M. Two- to 4-Year-Olds' Use of Generic Knowledge as Shared Knowledge. *Data collection ongoing.*

Works

- Rivero, A., **Vasil**, J., & Tomasello, M. (2026). *Three's a crowd: 2- and 3-year-olds coordinate decisions in dyads and triads*. Flash talk presented at *Cognitive Development Society Biennial Meeting*. Montreal.
- Rivero, A., **Vasil**, J., & Tomasello, M. (2026). *Three's a crowd: 2- and 3-year-olds coordinate decisions in dyads and triads*. Poster presented at *Cognitive Development Society Biennial Meeting*. Montreal.
- Rivero, A., **Vasil**, J., & Tomasello, M. (2026). *Three's a crowd: 2- and 3-year-olds coordinate decisions in dyads and triads*. Poster presented at *North Carolina Cognition Conference*. Durham, NC.

- Yilmaz, D., **Vasil**, J., Rhodes, M. (2026). Effects of Generics and Contextual Cues on 3- and 4-Year-Olds' Normative Inferences. Poster presented at *Cognitive Development Society Biennial Meeting*. Montreal.
- **Vasil**, J., & Rhodes, M. (2026). Four-Year-Olds' Use of Generic Knowledge as Shared Knowledge. Poster presented at *Cognitive Development Society Biennial Meeting*. Montreal.
- Pion, G., **Vasil**, J., Schwartz, E., Mandelbaum, E., & Rhodes, M. (2025). Generics, Explicit Quantifiers, and Essentialism. Poster presented at *Essentialism in the Human Mind*. Amherst, MA.
- **Vasil**, J. (2024). Effects of "We"-Framing and Prior Discourse on Young Children's Referential Informativeness. Doctoral dissertation, Department of Psychology and Neuroscience, Duke University. https://dukespace.lib.duke.edu/server/api/core/bitstreams/39effd5e-b9cb-43b7-81b9-455c5f600aec/content. Committee: Drs. Rick Hoyle, Tamar Kushnir, Michael Tomasello, and Makeba Wilbourn
- **Vasil**, J., Provençal, M., & Tomasello, M. (2024). Effects of "We"-framing and Partner Number on 2- and 3-Year-Olds' Commitment. Poster presented at *Cognitive Development Society Biennial Meeting*. Pasadena, CA.
- **Vasil**, J. & Tomasello, M. (2023). Thought and Language: Young Children's Interpretation of We. Poster presented at *Budapest CEU Conference on Cognitive Development*. Budapest, Hungary.
- **Vasil**, J. (2021). Evidence for a Cognitive Linguistic Model of Collaboration. Doctoral dissertation proposal, Department of Psychology and Neuroscience, Duke University. Committee: Drs. Rick Hoyle, Tamar Kushnir, Michael Tomasello, and Makeba Wilbourn
- **Vasil**, J. & Tomasello, M. (2021). Effects of 'We'-framing on Preschoolers' Commitment, Sharing, and Helping. Poster presented at *MK40: Common Knowledge, Common Ground, and Context in Communication*. Online (University College London).
- **Vasil**, J. (2021). Active Reference. Master's thesis, Department of Psychology and Neuroscience, Duke University. Committee: Drs. Karl Friston, Rick Hoyle, Michael Tomasello, and Makeba Wilbourn
- **Vasil**, J. & Tomasello, M. (2020). Effects of 'We'-framing on Preschoolers' Commitment, Sharing, and Helping. Poster presented at *Budapest CEU Conference on Cognitive Development*. Budapest, Hungary.
- **Vasil**, J. & Tomasello, M. (2019). Effects of 'We'-framing on Preschoolers' Commitment, Sharing, and Helping. Poster presented at *Duke-UNC Chapel Hill Annual Meeting in Developmental Psychology*. Durham, NC.
- **Vasil**, J. & Tomasello, M. (2019). Effects of 'We'-framing on Preschoolers' Commitment, Sharing, and Helping. Poster presented at *Cognitive Development Society Biennial Meeting*. Louisville, KY.
- Negoita, S., **Vasil**, J., & Li, L. (2019). Employing neuropragmatics and neurostimulation for decoding language from the brain. Poster presented at *Carolina Neurostimulation Conference.* Chapel Hill, NC.
- **Vasil**, J. (2018). *Homo*: A Principled Approach. Undergraduate Senior Thesis, University of Florida. http://ufdc.ufl.edu/AA00063285. Committee: Drs. Robert D'Amico, M. J. Farrar, Andreas Keil
- **Vasil**, J. (2017). Minimal Group Effects on Preschool Children's Acceptance of Incorrect Testimony Under Stepwise Reduction of Perceptual Uncertainty. Poster presented at

University of Florida, University Scholars Program Research Symposium. Gainesville, Florida.

Talks

- Joint Commitment and Partner Choice. (2025). Language and Concepts Working Group Meeting, New York University.
- Uniquely Human Computational Models of Reference. (2025). Computation and Decision-Making Lab, New York University.
- Uniquely Human Computational Models of Reference. (2025). Cognitive Development and Social Cognition Lab, New York University.
- Group-minded Thought and Language. (2024). Cognitive Development and Social Cognition Lab, New York University.
- Effects of "We"-Framing and Prior Discourse on Young Children's Referential Informativeness. (2024). Doctoral dissertation (oral defense), Duke University.
- Association of Group-mindedness with Young Children's Production and Interpretation of *We*. (2023). Normativity Colloquium, University of Konstanz. *Invited*.
- Thought and Language: Young Children's Production and Interpretation of *We*. (2023). Language Group Meeting, Princeton University. *Invited*.
- Thought and Language: Young Children's Production and Interpretation of *We*. (2023). Developmental-Social Area Brownbag, Duke University.
- Thought and Language: Young Children's Interpretation and Production of *We*. (2023). Developmental Area Brownbag, Duke University.
- Developmental and Evolutionary Perspectives on Joint Commitment. (2022). Guest Lecture, PSY103 (Developmental Psychology), Duke University.
- Young Children's Comprehension of *We*. (2022). Developmental Area Working Group Meeting, Duke University.
- Active Reference. (2021). Master's thesis (oral defense), Department of Psychology and Neuroscience, Duke University. Committee: Drs. Karl Friston, Rick Hoyle, Michael Tomasello, and Makeba Wilbourn
- Effects of "We"-framing and Prior Discourse on Young Children's Referring Expressions, Teaching, and Protest. (2021). Developmental Area Working Group Meeting, Duke University.
- Young English-speaking Children's Comprehension of the Word "We". (2021). Developmental Area Working Group Meeting, University of Virginia. *Invited*.
- English-speaking Preschoolers' First-person Plural Pronouns. (2020). Developmental Area Working Group Meeting, Duke University.
- We-framing: Effects on Cooperation and Communication in Children. (2019). Developmental Area Working Group Meeting, Duke University.

Funding

- Lafitte Foundation Graduate Travel Award ($1,250) (2024).
- Vertical Integration Program Fellow, Duke University ($1,800) (2022).
- Vertical Integration Program Fellow, Duke University ($1,800) (2020).
- Vertical Integration Program Fellow, Duke University ($1,800) (2019).
- Lafitte Foundation Graduate Travel Award ($1,055) (2019).

- Lafitte Foundation Graduate Research Award ($5,000) (2019). *The evolutionary origin of intention reading: testing Bottlenose Dolphins' (Tursiops truncatus) understanding of intentional versus accidental action*. With Wouter Wolf.
- Lafitte Foundation Graduate Travel Award ($810) (2018).
- University of Florida University Scholars Program ($1,750). (2016).

Teaching

- Developmental Psychology, PSY103 (TA, Duke University) (2022).
- Social Psychology, PSY104 (TA, Duke University) (2021).
- General Psychology, PSY101 (TA, Duke University) (2021).
- Decision Science, PSY141 (TA, Duke University) (2020)
- Developmental Psychology, PSY103 (TA, Duke University) (2019)
- General Psychology, PSY2012 (TA, University of Florida) (2017)

Mentoring

- Alissa Rivero (Senior Thesis Project Mentor, Duke University) (2024, 2026). Manuscript: Rivero, Vasil, & Tomasello (2026). Full reference above.
- Sarah Williams (Senior Thesis Project Mentor, Duke University) (2024, 2026). Manuscript: Williams, Vasil, & Tomasello (in preparation). Full reference above.
- Maya Provençal (Senior Thesis Mentor and Committee Member, Duke University) (2023). Publication: Vasil, Provençal, & Tomasello (2024). Full citation above.
- Camryn Capoot (Senior Thesis Mentor and Committee Member, Duke University) (2022). Publication: Vasil, Capoot, & Tomasello (2024). Full citation above.
- Dayna Price (Senior Thesis Mentor and Committee Member, Duke University) (2021). Publication: Vasil, Price, & Tomasello (2023). Full citation above.
- Kayla Harris (Senior Thesis Mentor and Committee Member, Duke University) (2020).

Service

Peer Review (journals). *Cognition*, *Cognitive Science*, *Developmental Science*, *Journal of Experimental Psychology: General*, *Social Development*

Peer Review (conferences). Budapest Conference on Childhood Cognitive Development

Reader (master's thesis). Grace Boudreau (2026, Department of Psychology, New York University)